

Editorial Board Responsibilities

Editor-in-Chief

The Editor-in-Chief provides academic leadership and strategic direction for the journal and serves as the primary guarantor of its scholarly quality, integrity, and development. The Editor-in-Chief oversees the journal's editorial operations to ensure that published content meets internationally recognized standards of peer review, research ethics, and academic rigor, in line with the requirements of Scopus and Web of Science.

The Editor-in-Chief works closely with the Editorial Board and the Editorial Office to ensure efficient manuscript handling while maintaining full editorial independence and transparency in decision-making.

Key Responsibilities

- Provide scholarly leadership and act as the principal academic representative of the journal, the publisher (TerraVeritas), and open access publishing within the research community.
- Define, review, and refine the journal's aims and scope to ensure scientific relevance, coherence, and alignment with the journal's objectives.
- Appoint and invite qualified, internationally recognized researchers to serve on the Editorial Board, ensuring disciplinary expertise and geographic diversity.
- Propose and approve topics for Special Issues and thematic collections, ensuring academic relevance and editorial oversight.
- Provide guidance and support to Section Editors, Editorial Board Members, and editorial staff, as needed, while preserving editorial independence.
- Maintain oversight of the peer-review process and take final responsibility for editorial decisions on individual manuscripts following peer review and revision.
- Ensure that peer review is conducted in accordance with TerraVeritas' peer-review policies, ethical standards, and international best practices (e.g., COPE guidelines).
- Uphold publication ethics, including the handling of conflicts of interest, research misconduct, and appeals.
- Chair the annual Editorial Board meeting and contribute to the strategic evaluation and continuous improvement of the journal.

Managing Editor

The Managing Editor supports the effective operation and strategic development of the journal through close coordination with the Editor-in-Chief, the Publishing Manager, and relevant TerraVeritas staff. The Managing Editor ensures timely communication, operational continuity, and adherence to established editorial policies and publishing standards.

Working under the academic leadership of the Editor-in-Chief, the Managing Editor provides editorial and administrative support to the Editor-in-Chief and Subject Editor(s) to ensure the integrity, efficiency, and quality of the editorial process.

Key Responsibilities

- Maintain regular and effective communication with the Editor-in-Chief, Publishing Manager, and TerraVeritas editorial teams, responding promptly to requests for support.
- Advise the Editor-in-Chief and Subject Editor(s) on the strategic development, positioning, and long-term sustainability of the journal.
- Provide guidance on the definition, review, and refinement of the journal's Aims and Scope at both journal and section levels.
- Support and advise Editorial Board Members and editorial staff in the execution of their roles, as required.
- Oversee the editorial workflow for manuscripts within assigned sections, including responsibility for final editorial decisions following peer review and author revisions, in accordance with journal policies.
- Propose and support the development of Special Issues and thematic collections, including the identification and invitation of qualified Guest Editors.
- Identify and invite suitably qualified and internationally recognized researchers to serve on the Editorial Board, ensuring appropriate subject expertise and diversity.
- Act as an academic and professional representative of the journal, TerraVeritas, and open access publishing within the scholarly community.

Advisory Board Members

Advisory Board Members provide independent, expert guidance to the Editor-in-Chief on the strategic development, academic direction, and policy framework of the journal. Their role is consultative in nature and supports the maintenance of high scholarly standards, ethical publishing practices, and long-term journal sustainability.

Key Responsibilities

- Provide expert assessment and guidance on new manuscript submissions when required, including cases involving potential conflicts of interest or complex editorial considerations.
- Recommend topics for Special Issues and advise on the establishment of new sections to ensure the journal's continued relevance and disciplinary coverage.
- Contribute feedback on journal policies, editorial procedures, and ethical guidelines to support continuous improvement and alignment with international publishing standards.
- Support the visibility and reputation of the journal by promoting it within academic networks and at relevant scholarly meetings and conferences.
- Participate in Advisory and Editorial Board meetings and contribute to discussions on strategic planning and journal development.
- Assist the Editor-in-Chief, when requested, in the resolution of appeals, complaints, and ethical issues, in accordance with established publication ethics and best-practice guidelines.

Editorial Board Members

Editorial Board Members contribute to the academic quality, integrity, and development of the journal by providing subject-matter expertise and supporting the peer-review and

editorial decision-making processes. They act under the leadership of the Editor-in-Chief and are expected to uphold the journal's editorial policies, ethical standards, and international best practices in scholarly publishing.

Key Responsibilities

- Conduct initial assessments of newly submitted manuscripts within their area of expertise to evaluate suitability, originality, and alignment with the journal's aims and scope.
- Make editorial recommendations and, where delegated, final editorial decisions on manuscripts following peer review and revision, in accordance with journal policies.
- Lead, edit, or supervise at least one Special Issue or thematic collection during their term, ensuring academic relevance and editorial oversight.
- Support the recruitment of high-quality submissions by engaging established researchers and encouraging early-career scholars to contribute to the journal or participate in topical advisory initiatives.
- Provide constructive input on journal policies, editorial procedures, and strategic development initiatives.
- Promote the journal within professional networks and at relevant academic conferences and events.
- Participate in Editorial Board meetings and contribute to discussions on journal performance, scope development, and long-term strategy.
- Serve as peer reviewers when requested, ensuring fair, timely, and confidential evaluation of manuscripts.

Subject Editors

Subject Editors are appointed based on their recognized research expertise and are assigned responsibility for specific subject areas or categories. They work in collaboration with the Editorial Boards across the TerraVeritas journal portfolio to strengthen subject coverage, support topical development, and enhance the academic visibility of the journals.

Subject Editors contribute to the strategic development of subject areas while upholding the journal's editorial policies, peer-review standards, and ethical guidelines.

Key Responsibilities

- Contribute to the development of subject-area strategies by proposing new topical initiatives and identifying emerging research trends.
- Collaborate with academic institutions, research centers, and scholarly networks to support the development and promotion of subject-focused topics.
- Identify and invite suitably qualified and internationally recognized researchers to serve as Subject Editors or contributors within the relevant category.
- Invite established and emerging scholars to submit high-quality manuscripts aligned with the journal's aims and scope.
- Recommend themes, subject areas, and appropriate journals within the TerraVeritas portfolio for the development of topical collections or initiatives.

- Promote subject-area topics and journal initiatives through academic conferences, professional networks, and relevant scholarly communication channels, including appropriate use of social media.

Editorial Staff

The Editorial Staff support the editorial decision-making process by conducting essential compliance, ethics, and research integrity checks to ensure that all submissions meet the journal's policies and internationally accepted publishing standards. These checks are performed in accordance with TerraVeritas guidelines and do not interfere with the academic independence of editorial decisions.

Key Responsibilities

- Verify the presence of appropriate ethics committee approvals and permissions for research involving human participants, animals, biological samples, or cell lines, where applicable.
- Screen submissions for plagiarism, redundant or duplicate publication, and confirm that necessary permissions have been obtained for the reuse of copyrighted material, including figures, tables, and images.
- Confirm the registration of clinical trials in recognized public registries and ensure that registration details are appropriately cited within the Materials and Methods section.
- Conduct additional compliance, ethical, and research integrity checks as required under TerraVeritas policies, journal guidelines, and internationally recognized best practices.